

FOR SUCH A TIME AS THIS

* DENOTES POWER POINT SLIDE

** DENOTES INSTRUCTIONS TO
TECHNICIAN

TEXT: [Esther 4:1-17](#) (NKJV) *“When Mordecai learned all that had happened, he tore his clothes and put on sackcloth and ashes, and went out into the midst of the city. He cried out with a loud and bitter cry. ²He went as far as the front of the king’s gate, for no one might enter the king’s gate clothed with sackcloth. ³And in every province where the king’s command and decree arrived, there was great mourning among the Jews, with fasting, weeping, and wailing; and many lay in sackcloth and ashes. ⁴So Esther’s maids and eunuchs came and told her, and the queen was deeply distressed. Then she sent garments to clothe Mordecai and take his sackcloth away from him, but he would not accept them. ⁵Then Esther called Hathach, one of the king’s eunuchs whom he had appointed to attend her, and she gave him a command concerning Mordecai, to learn what and why this was. ⁶So Hathach went out to Mordecai in the city square that was in front of the king’s gate. ⁷And Mordecai told him all that had happened to him, and the sum of money that Haman had promised to pay into the king’s treasuries to destroy the Jews. ⁸He also gave him a copy of the written decree for their destruction, which was given at Shushan, that he might show it to Esther and explain it to her, and that he might command her to go in to*

the king to make supplication to him and plead before him for her people. ⁹So Hathach returned and told Esther the words of Mordecai. ¹⁰Then Esther spoke to Hathach, and gave him a command for Mordecai: ¹¹“All the king’s servants and the people of the king’s provinces know that any man or woman who goes into the inner court to the king, who has not been called, he has but one law: put all to death, except the one to whom the king holds out the golden scepter, that he may live. Yet I myself have not been called to go in to the king these thirty days.” ¹²So they told Mordecai Esther’s words. ¹³And Mordecai told them to answer Esther: “Do not think in your heart that you will escape in the king’s palace any more than all the other Jews. ¹⁴“For if you remain completely silent at this time, relief and deliverance will arise for the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. Yet who knows whether you have come to the kingdom for such a time as this?” ¹⁵Then Esther told them to reply to Mordecai: ¹⁶“Go, gather all the Jews who are present in Shushan, and fast for me; neither eat nor drink for three days, night or day. My maids and I will fast likewise. And so I will go to the king, which is against the law; and if I perish, I perish!” ¹⁷So Mordecai went his way and did according to all that Esther commanded him.”

INTRO: The book of Esther was written by Ezra. The book of Esther is a relatively short book, ten chapters and one hundred sixty five verses, but what a story it tells!

If we had time it would be very interesting to do an in depth study of each of the characters in this book, as each of them are very colorful individuals. In the interest of time **we are going to focus our time on five main characters: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- **Ahasuerus** - He is the king who ruled during the time of the Babylonian captivity.
- **Vashti** – She was the queen of Ahasuerus. The book of Esther depicts Vashti as a very vain, self-willed person. Vashti means beauty. Esther 1:11 (NKJV) The King commands his servants ***“to bring Queen Vashti before the king, wearing her royal crown, in order to show her beauty to the people and the officials, for she was beautiful to behold.”***
- **Mordecai** – Mordecai is from the tribe of Benjamin, however he is called a Jew, proving that the term “Jew” is used of any Israelite and not just of the tribe of Judah only. In the book of Esther the term “Jew” is even applied to gentiles who became proselytes.
- **Esther** – Esther was the niece of Mordecai who was brought to the king’s house to enter the contest to determine who was the most beautiful, and talented virgin in all the empire.

To make a long story short, Esther won the favor of the king, as well as the contest, and became the queen of Ahasuerus!

- **Haman** - Haman had a very successful career as a prince under Ahasuerus, and was eventually made second in command.

I. THE PATH TO THE KINGDOM

The story of the book of Esther begins with King Ahasuerus having a great banquet and celebration. On the seventh day of this celebration in the midst of a drunken stupor, the King requests for his servants to bring Vashti in to show off her beauty.

When Vashti receives this request she does a very alarming, surprising thing. **(PLACE SCRIPTURES ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)** Esther 1:23 (NKJV) *“Queen Vashti refused to come at the king’s command...”* The decision of the Queen did not go over well with the inebriated King! Esther 1:12 (NKJV) *“The king was furious, and his anger burned within him.”*

The king was not the only one who became angry; his princes weigh in on the refusal of the Queen to obey the very direct command of the King! Esther 1:16-18 (NKJV) *“Queen Vashti has not only wronged the king, but also all the princes, and all the people who are in all the provinces of King Ahasuerus.”*¹⁷*“For*

the queen's behavior will become known to all women, so that they will despise their husbands in their eyes, when they report, 'King Ahasuerus commanded Queen Vashti to be brought in before him, but she did not come.' ¹⁸*"This very day the noble ladies of Persia and Media will say to all the king's officials that they have heard of the behavior of the queen. Thus there will be excessive contempt and wrath."*

The rebellion of Vashti meets with extremely severe consequences! Esther 1:19-21 (NKJV) *"If it pleases the king, let a royal decree go out from him, and let it be recorded in the laws of the Persians and the Medes, so that it will not be altered, that Vashti shall come no more before King Ahasuerus; and let the king give her royal position to another who is better than she."* ²⁰*"When the king's decree which he will make is proclaimed throughout all his empire (for it is great), all wives will honor their husbands, both great and small."* ²¹*And the reply pleased the king and the princes, and the king did according to the word of Memucan."* Rebellion at any level cannot go unchallenged! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** Rebellion meets with the most severe disapproval of God! All rebels will eventually be judged!

By the end of the first chapter of this book we have a very peculiar situation, a king without a queen! This is

not acceptable; therefore another Queen must be chosen.

The Princes hatch a plan that will send a statement across the Kingdom! The most beautiful young virgins from across the Kingdom would be brought to the palace to compete for the Kings approval and be chosen to become the Queen. Needless to say, Ahasuerus was 100% for this plan! Wouldn't you guys be?

During the days of the Babylonian captivity, though Ezekiel and Daniel remained in Babylon, for some reason Mordecai was taken to Shushan, where the palace was located. Never forget, **God always has a plan. (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

Mordecai was the aged cousin of Esther. When Esther's parents and family were killed, Mordecai brought Esther into his house and cared for her as if she were his own daughter. This deed tells me something about Mordecai.

Esther becomes one of the contestants in this contest to become Queen. Notice **the attitude of Esther during this contest. Esther 2:15 (NKJV) *"Now when the turn came for Esther the daughter of Abihail the uncle of Mordecai, who had taken her as his daughter, to go in to the king, she requested nothing but what Hegai the king's eunuch, the custodian of the women,***

advised. And Esther obtained favor in the sight of all who saw her. Certain necessary things were appointed to be given to each of the candidates for Queen-ship, but any other thing they might wish for, for the beautification of the person, or might help them win the favor of the king, was not to be denied them.

The others evidently required many other things to perfect their preparation but it is noted of Esther that, *“she required nothing.”*

Can you imagine how many outfits, dresses and shoes were tried on? Esther chose to be satisfied with *“those things appointed by the king.”* Esther left herself entirely in the hands of the person who had the work of preparation committed to him. Please know the person in charge of finding a bride knows better than anyone else what the King is looking for!

What is our King looking for in a bride? **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Love
- Joy
- Peace
- Long-suffering
- Gentleness
- Goodness

- Faith
- Meekness
- Temperance

The humility and faith of Esther are now rewarded by a public manifestation of the king's favor. Esther 2:16-17 (NKJV) ***"So Esther was taken to King Ahasuerus, into his royal palace, in the tenth month, which is the month of Tebeth, in the seventh year of his reign. ¹⁷The king loved Esther more than all the other women, and she obtained grace and favor in his sight more than all the virgins; so he set the royal crown upon her head and made her queen instead of Vashti."*** She is now crowned with glory and honor! It is note-worthy that she did nothing to deserve the glory and honor except obey!

The way to the throne was open to her when the king loved her. What an awesome privilege and honor to be loved by a king, the king of heaven. The love of God opens the way for us into the very heart of God! **The only requirement to obtaining His favor is to be obedient! (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL END OF THE SERVICE)**

The crown the queen wore was a symbol of honor and power. When we become obedient to all that the King has commanded we embark upon a life of honor and

power! O how I want to be crowned with his glory everyday!

II. HINDRANCES TO THE KINGDOM LIFE

One of the Kings Princes is promoted to a place of second in command in the house of the King of Babylon. When Haman was promoted to this lofty position he decided that everyone should bow to him when he was in their presence. A little authority goes a long ways with some people! **It is possible to promote a person to a level that their character cannot sustain! (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** This is the case with Haman!

Everyone bowed at the feet of Haman, except Mordecai!

Mordecai would not bow to Haman and Haman hated him because he did not.

In the process of time Mordecai discovered that two of the king's chamberlains had devised a plot to assassinate Ahasuerus, Mordecai tells Esther, Esther tells Ahasuerus, and the plot is foiled! (Keep that in mind, we are going to discuss it later!)

Each of us should remember that **the road to our destiny is littered with difficulty, problems, detours,**

and distractions! (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

Haman's hatred of Mordecai eventually took in the entire Jewish race of people, and Haman devises a plot to kill all the Jews, including Mordecai. Esther 3:8-11 (NKJV) *"Then Haman said to King Ahasuerus, 'There is a certain people scattered and dispersed among the people in all the provinces of your kingdom; their laws are different from all other people's, and they do not keep the king's laws. Therefore it is not fitting for the king to let them remain.'"* ⁹*"If it pleases the king, let a decree be written that they be destroyed, and I will pay ten thousand talents of silver into the hands of those who do the work, to bring it into the king's treasuries."* ¹⁰*So the king took his signet ring from his hand and gave it to Haman, the son of Hammedatha the Agagite, the enemy of the Jews.* ¹¹*And the king said to Haman, 'The money and the people are given to you, to do with them as seems good to you.'*

That's the way bitterness always behaves, it can never be satisfied with just locking one person into a personal prison of isolation. Bitterness must always include others. (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE) Bitterness can never get enough victims; it continually looks for more people to bring into its grasp! The destiny of many people has been sidetracked by the allowance of bitterness in ones life!

Two things Haman was unaware of: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Mordecai's God
- The Queen was Jewish

Haman was willing to pay 10,000 talents of silver at \$1,920.00 each, or \$19,200,000.00 to get rid of the Jews.

Mordecai sends word to Esther of the plot of Haman to destroy the Jews. Esther 4:10-14 (NKJV) *“Esther spoke to Hathach, and gave him a command for Mordecai: ¹¹“All the king’s servants and the people of the king’s provinces know that any man or woman who goes into the inner court to the king, who has not been called, he has but one law: put all to death, except the one to whom the king holds out the golden scepter, that he may live. Yet I myself have not been called to go in to the king these thirty days.” ¹²So they told Mordecai Esther’s words. ¹³And Mordecai told them to answer Esther: “Do not think in your heart that you will escape in the king’s palace any more than all the other Jews. ¹⁴“For if you remain completely silent at this time, relief and deliverance will arise for the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. Yet who knows whether you have come to the kingdom for such a time as this?”*

Mordecai tells Esther that her reason for being in the palace was specifically for this purpose! She was not there simply because she was prettier or more gifted than the others, she was there because the Jewish people were going to need an intercessor! Her beauty and grace were given to her so she could be at the right place at the right time! **God has gifted each of us for a specific purpose! (LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** Will we be at the right place at the right time so we can fulfill His purpose?

Notice, Mordecai said, ***“For if you remain completely silent at this time, relief and deliverance will arise for the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish.”*** The question is not whether God is going to accomplish His purpose; the real question is whether we will be where He intended us to be, doing what He intended us to do so we could participate in His plan on the earth!

No-one ever promised the Kingdom life would be easy but it will be rewarding!

In the very face of death Esther decides to become an intercessor for the Jewish people! She goes before the king and he receives her. She invites the king and Haman to a banquet meal that she will make. They enjoy the evening together and she invites them to another banquet the next day!

Haman leaves the palace excited about the prospect of dining two days in a row with the King and Queen! Proverbs 16:18 (NKJV) ***“Pride goes before destruction and a haughty spirit before a fall.”***

Outside of disobedience, bitterness and pride may be the greatest hindrances to the Kingdom life!

As Haman is leaving the palace grounds he sees Mordecai and Mordecai refuse's to bow before him! Haman is angry; he goes home and tells his wife, his wife convinces him to build a gallows which is seventy five feet high on which he would hang Mordecai the next day! Do you see how **pride and bitterness makes a ridiculous spectacle of its victims?** **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTILL THE END OF SERVICE)** Mordecai was not sixty five feet tall! Why do you need a gallows seventy five feet tall? Because pride wants to make sure everyone can witness the execution, and bitterness wants to make sure its victim is dead!

III. GOD HAS THE FINAL SAY IN THE KINGDOM LIFE

That night God began to deal with Ahasuerus and Ahasuerus remembers the kindness of Mordecai when the chamberlains plotted to kill him. Esther 6:1-10 (NKJV) ***“That night the king could not sleep. So one was commanded to bring the book of the records of***

the chronicles; and they were read before the king.
²And it was found written that Mordecai had told of Bigthana and Teresh, two of the king's eunuchs, the doorkeepers who had sought to lay hands on King Ahasuerus. ³Then the king said, "What honor or dignity has been bestowed on Mordecai for this?"
And the king's servants who attended him said, "Nothing has been done for him."
⁴So the king said, "Who is in the court?" Now Haman had just entered the outer court of the king's palace to suggest that the king hang Mordecai on the gallows that he had prepared for him. ⁵The king's servants said to him, "Haman is there, standing in the court." And the king said, "Let him come in." ⁶So Haman came in, and the king asked him, "What shall be done for the man whom the king delights to honor?"
Now Haman thought in his heart, "Whom would the king delight to honor more than me?"
⁷And Haman answered the king, "For the man whom the king delights to honor, ⁸let a royal robe be brought which the king has worn, and a horse on which the king has ridden, which has a royal crest placed on its head. ⁹"Then let this robe and horse be delivered to the hand of one of the king's most noble princes, that he may array the man whom the king delights to honor. Then parade him on horseback through the city square, and proclaim before him: 'Thus shall it be done to the man whom the king delights to honor!'"
¹⁰Then the king said to Haman, "Hurry, take the robe and the

horse, as you have suggested, and do so for Mordecai the Jew who sits within the king's gate! Leave nothing undone of all that you have spoken." Have you ever been in a situation where it seems that justice will never be done, the truth will never surface, you will never be vindicated? Romans 12:19 (KJV) *"Vengeance is Mine, I will repay," says the Lord."*

Trust me, God knows how to turn the tables on the enemy! Esther 6:11-14 (NKJV) *"So Haman took the robe and the horse, arrayed Mordecai and led him on horseback through the city square, and proclaimed before him, "Thus shall it be done to the man whom the king delights to honor!"* ¹²*Afterward Mordecai went back to the king's gate. But Haman hurried to his house, mourning and with his head covered.* ¹³*When Haman told his wife Zeresh and all his friends everything that had happened to him, his wise men and his wife Zeresh said to him, "If Mordecai, before whom you have begun to fall, is of Jewish descent, you will not prevail against him but will surely fall before him."* ¹⁴*While they were still talking with him, the king's eunuchs came, and hastened to bring Haman to the banquet which Esther had prepared."*

Haman comes to the banquet that Esther had prepared the next day. Notice what happens. Esther 7:1-19 (NKJV) *"So the king and Haman went to dine with Queen Esther. ²And on the second day, at the*

banquet of wine, the king again said to Esther, "What is your petition, Queen Esther? It shall be granted you. And what is your request, up to half the kingdom? It shall be done!"³ Then Queen Esther answered and said, "If I have found favor in your sight, O king, and if it pleases the king, let my life be given me at my petition, and my people at my request."⁴ "For we have been sold, my people and I, to be destroyed, to be killed, and to be annihilated. Had we been sold as male and female slaves, I would have held my tongue, although the enemy could never compensate for the king's loss."⁵ So King Ahasuerus answered and said to Queen Esther, "Who is he, and where is he, who would dare presume in his heart to do such a thing?"⁶ And Esther said, "The adversary and enemy is this wicked Haman!" So Haman was terrified before the king and queen.⁷ Then the king arose in his wrath from the banquet of wine and went into the palace garden; but Haman stood before Queen Esther, pleading for his life, for he saw that evil was determined against him by the king.⁸ When the king returned from the palace garden to the place of the banquet of wine, Haman had fallen across the couch where Esther was. Then the king said, "Will he also assault the queen while I am in the house?" As the word left the king's mouth, they covered Haman's face.⁹ Now Harbonah, one of the eunuchs, said to the king, "Look! The gallows, fifty cubits high, which Haman made for Mordecai, who spoke good on the king's behalf, is standing at the house of Haman." Then the king said, "Hang him on it!"¹⁰ So they hanged Haman on the gallows that he had

prepared for Mordecai. Then the king's wrath subsided."

CONCLUSION:

If we will be faithful and obedient we will live the Kingdom life! **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** Isaiah 1:19-20 (NKJV) *"If you are willing and obedient, You shall eat the good of the land;
²⁰But if you refuse and rebel, You shall be devoured by the sword"; For the mouth of the LORD has spoken."*

I have a prediction for CT, and the people who attend this church; 2009 will be a turn-around year for this church and its people! **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF SERVICE)**
**WE HAVE COME TO THE
KINGDOM FOR SUCH A TIME AS
THIS!**